

CARNATIONS AND PINKS

Although perhaps best known for providing excellent, long-lasting cut flowers, carnations and pinks (*Dianthus* cultivars) are highly ornamental border subjects, valued for their usually fragrant, clove-scented blooms, produced over a long period in summer, and their distinctive, silvery- or gray-green foliage. Shorter-growing cultivars—the old-fashioned and modern pinks—make excellent edging plants. Many of the flowers are attractively marked or have fringed petals. Carnations and pinks need an open, sunny position, preferably in alkaline soil. All except the perpetual-flowering carnations are frost hardy, and most can be easily propagated from cuttings. The myriad of carnation and pinks cultivars are divided into the following groups:

Border carnations—plants are of upright habit and flower prolifically in midsummer in a single flush; each stem bears 5 or more flowers. Picotee-flowered forms, with petals outlined in a darker, contrasting color, are available.

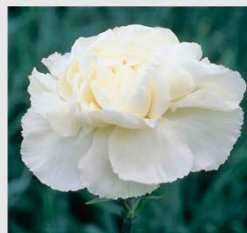
Perpetual-flowering carnations—similar in habit to border carnations, they are usually grown for cut flowers and bloom year-round under glass. Plants are normally disbudded, leaving one flower per stem, but spray forms have up to 5 flowers per stem.

Malmaison carnations—these produce intensely fragrant flowers sporadically throughout the year under glass.

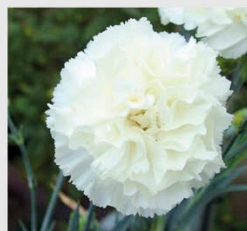
Old-fashioned pinks—these have a low, spreading habit and form neat cushions of foliage; masses of fragrant flowers are produced in midsummer. Good for border edging and cutting.

Modern pinks—usually more vigorous than old-fashioned pinks, they are repeat-flowering and produce 2 or 3 main flushes of flowers in summer. Cut or deadhead to encourage further flowering.

Alpine pinks—in early summer, these plants form cushions of small, scented flowers. Good for edging, or in a rockery, raised bed, trough, or alpine house.



D. 'Crompton Princess'
[perpetual-flowering carnation]



D. 'Milky Way'
[perpetual-flowering carnation]



D. 'Devon Flavia'
[modern pink]



D. 'White Ladies'
[old-fashioned pink]



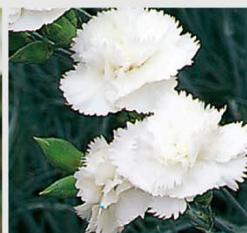
D. 'Becky Robinson'
[modern pink]



D. 'Mrs Sinkins'
[old-fashioned pink]



D. 'Musgrave's Pink'
[old-fashioned pink]



D. 'Haytor White'
[modern pink]



D. 'Brilliant Star'
[modern pink]



D. 'Gran's Favourite'
[old-fashioned pink]



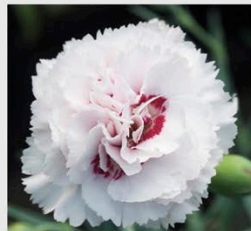
D. 'Doris'
[modern pink]



D. 'Duchess of Westminster'
[Malmaison carnation]



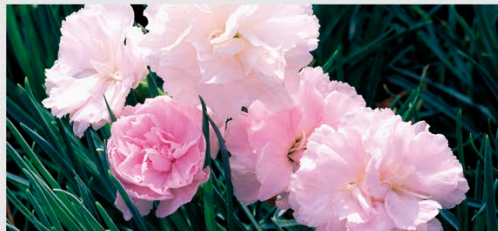
D. 'Dad's Favourite'
[old-fashioned pink]



D. 'Cranmere Pool' [modern]



D. 'Devon Dove' [modern]



D. 'Inchmerry' [old-fashioned pink]



D. 'Evening Star' [modern pink]